



Figurative Language





CPALMS Standard

- **ELA.2.R.3.1, ELA.3.R.3.1:** Identify and explain similes, idioms, alliteration, metaphors, personification, and hyperbole in texts.



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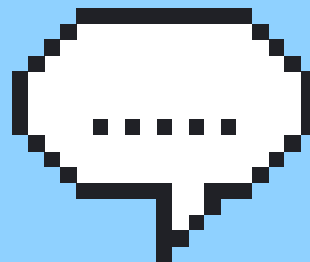
**Passages
with
Figurative
Language**





Ice Breaker

What would your dream house look like and where would it be?





Figurative vs Literal Language



Figurative

Language that uses words or expressions with a meaning that is different from the actual interpretation



Literal

Type of language that is spoken most of the time. It expresses thoughts and ideas very clearly.



Literal vs Figurative Descriptions

Literal

Figurative

The grass looks green.

The grass looks like spiky green hair.

The cake smells sweet.

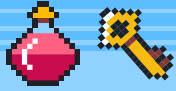
The cake has the sweetest smelling frosting in the world.

It's raining heavily.

It's raining cats and dogs.

My backpack is light.

My backpack is as light as a feather.



Figurative Language

Simile: 'like' or 'as'

Hyperbole: exaggeration

Alliteration: words starting with the same sound

Metaphor: directing comparison using 'is', 'are', or 'was'

Personification: giving human qualities to animals or inanimate objects

Idiom: figurative phrase/expression with a symbolic meaning





Simile

Comparing two things using 'like' or 'as'

- Examples: I am as brave as a lion
 - I slept like a log
 - Life is like a box of chocolates

In these examples, what two objects are we comparing?

Hyperbole



An exaggeration to create an effect

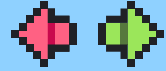
- Examples: I am so hungry I can eat a horse.
 - I have a million things to do.
 - It's so fluffy I'm going to die!!

Try to interpret these examples in a literal meaning.





Alliteration



Repetition of similar sounds in a group of words

- Examples: She sells seashells by the seashore.
 - Lazy lions lounge in the sun.
 - Busy buzzing bees.

Metaphor

Comparing two things without using 'like' or 'as'

- Examples: He is night owl.
 - Her temper was a volcano waiting to erupt.
 - Your hug is a warm blanket on a cold day.

What objects are we comparing?





Personification



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Giving human qualities to animals or other inanimate objects

- Examples: The tree leaves danced in the wind.
 - My alarm clock yelled at me.
 - The stars winked at us.

Can you identify the human qualities?

Idiom



Group of words or phrase with a figurative meaning that is not easily understood

- Examples: When pigs fly.
 - Break a leg.
 - Piece of cake.

Under what conditions have you heard these phrases?



Practice

Identify the simile, metaphor, or hyperbole:

- I would really like a bed like the one in that hotel. Sleeping on it was like sleeping on a cloud.
- My mouth is on fire!! I need some milk!!
- When my brother is home, the house is an active circus. But when he leaves, the house is a relaxing spa day.

Try to make your own example with similes, metaphors, and hyperboles.



Practice

Identify the alliteration or personification:

- Which of the water slides at Wild Water West is your favorite? I like the blue slide because it twists and turns hundreds of times!
- During the drought, the plants dropped toward the ground begging for water. But when it rained, they danced and slurped up the moisture.

Try to make your own example with personification and alliteration.



Practice

Living with a five year old brother can be like riding a roller coaster. Sometimes he is like an angel when he gives me hugs after school and holds my hand on walks. Other times, he is a monster. He trashes my room making it look like a dumpster and cries for what seems like forever. His behavior is particularly puzzling.



Practice

Molly's stomach was begging for the last slice of pizza. The cheesy crispy crust kept calling her name. A slice with a golden crust like that of a sunset and a silky smooth tomato sauce. It was like she had been starving for eternity. After caving to its calling, Molly's stomach was not agreeing with her. Her stomach had a growl of a lion urging her to find the nearest bathroom.



End of Lesson Questions



- What is your favorite figurative language type?
- When would you use these expressions?
- How would they benefit your writing?



Additional Resources to Practice

[Quizlet Figurative Language Practice](#)

[Similes and Metaphors Quiz](#)

[Figurative Language Game Show](#)